

. . . all kinds of things where somebody does more than is absolutely necessary for the sake of the feeling they get by doing it.

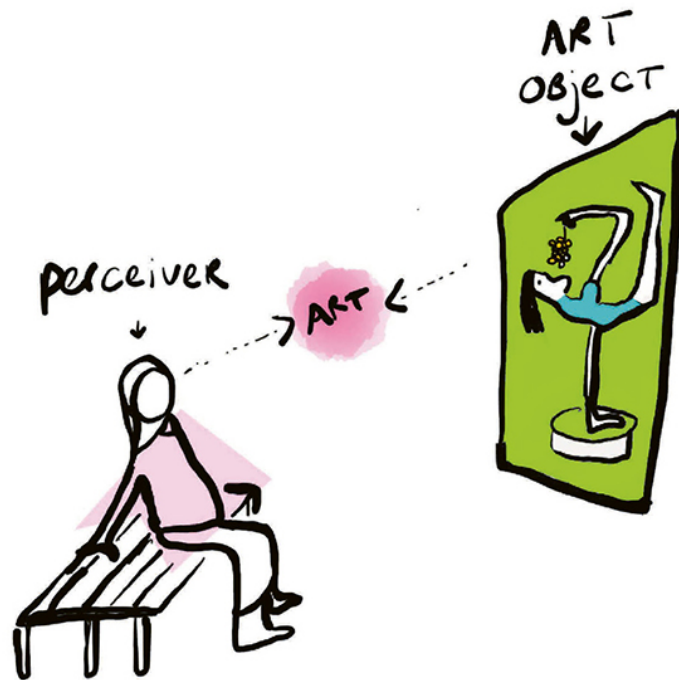
WE HAVE TO	WE DON'T HAVE TO
GATHER FOOD	ADD SPRINKLES
EAT & DRINK	DESIGN SILVERWARE
CONSTRUCT SHELTER	HANG WALLPAPER
COMMUNICATE	DO IMPROV
MAINTAIN BODY	DO BODYBUILDING

There are things we have to do to stay alive like eat food, drink liquid, wear clothes, make money, communicate with each other. And on top of those things we do thousands of other things that we don't have to do:



we embroider our clothes
we decorate our food
we compose poems
we arrange flowers
we mix colours
we play instruments
we invent slang
we adorn our bodies
we curate exhibitions
we sing and
we dance and
we hum and
we drum

None of those things are necessary, but we put them into
our lives with them. We like the feelings they give us.



**we all make art
all the time
but we don't usually
call it that**

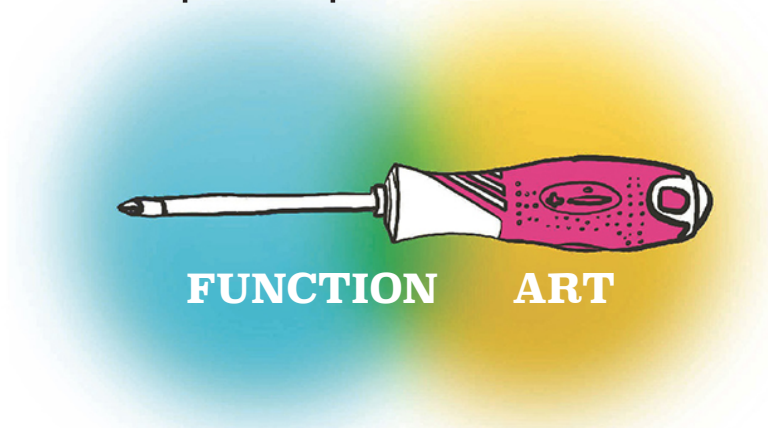
Artists are people who've decided to make of it. Every time somebody puts on their nose up, chooses their jewellery and clothes, does this way or that, puts on a record, art is being made.

When we speak of an art object we mean 'something that is intended to trigger some feeling'. Art is not a substance that radiates out of paintings or symphonies. Art is a name we give a certain type of experience. It's the name of a kind of engagement we have with something.

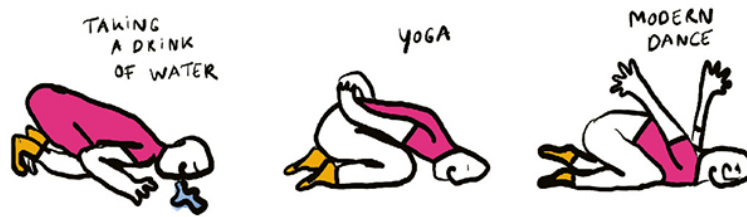
What type of engagement is an art engagement? To understand this, let's think about screwdrivers.

A screwdriver has two parts: the blade and the handle. The blade can really only be made in one form for a specific purpose and it has to be a specific size and strength. You couldn't make it out of glass or chocolate. It wouldn't be able to turn a screw. If you go to a hardware store and look at a display of flat screwdrivers you'll see that all the blades are virtually identical.

This is not true for the handles. There is no space for variation in the blades – but there is in the handles, which can be striped or speckled or multicoloured or opaque.



These variations in the handles make no difference to the usability of the tools. They are stylistic variations that don't relate to function.



FUNCTION → **ART**

The less functional a thing is – the less it has something in particular – the more space there is in it; the more freedom there is in it.



FUNCTION → **ART**

The art engagement begins where the functional engagement ends.

If you're designing a cup that you intend people to drink from, it has to be able to hold liquid. A perforated cup won't work, even if it is very beautiful.

The degrees of freedom in what you do with a cup are limited by the fact that it has a real-world use: to carry liquid and it has to be drinkable from.

If, on the other hand, you're Grayson Perry or McNicoll, making cups as art objects, there are no restrictions of that kind. You can make the cup any shape you want with as many holes in it as you like. You can paint it with any material you like. You're not expecting anybody to drink from such a cup.

Because it doesn't have a real-world use, it isn't strained. It has a lot of space for art.

Art can always be otherwise.